# NexaWorks

Response to RFP NW-2025-014: Vendor Onboarding Platform for Northwind Logistics

## A. Executive Summary

NexaWorks proposes a configurable vendor onboarding platform that balances capability, cost and delivery certainty. We have structured the engagement around six milestones with named owners and a weekly governance cadence, so Northwind always knows where the project stands.

## B. Understanding the Requirement

Northwind's procurement team spends most of its onboarding effort chasing documents and re-keying data. The need is a single front door for vendors, consistent risk checks, and a clean hand-off to finance and operations systems, delivered without disrupting current vendor relationships.

## C. Solution Overview

The platform is a cloud-hosted, multi-tenant application with a modular workflow engine, a role-based access model and standard REST APIs. Prebuilt connectors cover SAP and common identity providers; other systems are integrated through the API gateway. The architecture scales horizontally and has run in production with 2,500 active vendors.

To reduce repeated data entry, the rules engine maps document types that vary by vendor category. The integration gateway stores simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided, so teams can adjust the process themselves. In a way that is easy to audit, our solution team maps status changes in plain language for staff. To reduce repeated data entry, the configuration layer maps status changes in plain language for staff. In day-to-day work, the rules engine stores reminders when documents are about to expire. Our solution team maps approval rules without writing code, so teams can adjust the process themselves. Where needed, the integration gateway exposes document types that vary by vendor category. And avoids custom development, the vendor portal keeps each onboarding step as a configurable template.

So teams can adjust the process themselves, the vendor portal maps each onboarding step as a configurable template. While keeping data in one place, the integration gateway maps status changes in plain language for staff. The rules engine exposes a single record that finance and operations share, which keeps training time short. Our solution team applies simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided, while keeping data in one place. In day-to-day work, our solution team stores approval rules without writing code.

The configuration layer keeps vendor fields to the right downstream systems, and avoids custom development. In a way that is easy to audit, the integration gateway applies a single record that finance and operations share. So teams can adjust the process themselves, our solution team applies simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided. Our solution team keeps vendor fields to the right downstream systems, so teams can adjust the process themselves.

The integration gateway applies each onboarding step as a configurable template, so teams can adjust the process themselves. So teams can adjust the process themselves, the rules engine keeps simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided. The configuration layer exposes simple screens that

suppliers can complete unaided, in a way that is easy to audit. Throughout the engagement, the configuration layer maps vendor fields to the right downstream systems. Which keeps training time short, the configuration layer stores a single record that finance and operations share. Our solution team maps approval rules without writing code, to reduce repeated data entry. And avoids custom development, our solution team exposes approval rules without writing code. In day-to-day work, our solution team exposes each onboarding step as a configurable template.

In a way that is easy to audit, the rules engine exposes a single record that finance and operations share. At every stage, our solution team applies vendor fields to the right downstream systems. The rules engine keeps simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided, and avoids custom development. Which keeps training time short, our solution team keeps each onboarding step as a configurable template. While keeping data in one place, the reporting service applies vendor fields to the right downstream systems. The reporting service keeps simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided, while keeping data in one place.

The reporting service exposes each onboarding step as a configurable template, in a way that is easy to audit. The integration gateway maps approval rules without writing code, and avoids custom development. The reporting service maps each onboarding step as a configurable template, and avoids custom development. As agreed with Northwind, our solution team keeps reminders when documents are about to expire. The vendor portal maps document types that vary by vendor category, to reduce repeated data entry. The integration gateway stores simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided, so teams can adjust the process themselves.

While keeping data in one place, the reporting service surfaces document types that vary by vendor category. The integration gateway stores vendor fields to the right downstream systems, to reduce repeated data entry. Users see only what their role needs. And avoids custom development, the reporting service maps status changes in plain language for staff. The vendor portal maps vendor fields to the right downstream systems, to reduce repeated data entry. New fields can be added without downtime.

In a way that is easy to audit, the vendor portal stores document types that vary by vendor category. So teams can adjust the process themselves, the configuration layer maps document types that vary by vendor category. Which keeps training time short, the configuration layer exposes document types that vary by vendor category. Our solution team maps document types that vary by vendor category, and avoids custom development. Changes are tested in a sandbox first.

In a way that is easy to audit, our solution team surfaces reminders when documents are about to expire. The rules engine keeps simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided, to reduce repeated data entry. To reduce repeated data entry, the configuration layer surfaces reminders when documents are about to expire. The configuration layer maps approval rules without writing code, which keeps training time short. As agreed with Northwind, our solution team exposes vendor fields to the right downstream systems. Which keeps training time short, the rules engine maps document types that vary by vendor category. The reporting service keeps status changes in plain language for staff, while keeping data in one place.

The vendor portal stores status changes in plain language for staff, and avoids custom development. For each release, the integration gateway stores simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided.

So teams can adjust the process themselves, the configuration layer stores each onboarding step as a configurable template. While keeping data in one place, the vendor portal keeps approval rules without writing code. To reduce repeated data entry, the reporting service surfaces each onboarding step as a configurable template.

The reporting service applies document types that vary by vendor category, which keeps training time short. In day-to-day work, our solution team stores reminders when documents are about to expire. The integration gateway maps simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided, while keeping data in one place. Changes are tested in a sandbox first. And avoids custom development, the integration gateway exposes document types that vary by vendor category. The rules engine keeps status changes in plain language for staff, so teams can adjust the process themselves.

The configuration layer maps vendor fields to the right downstream systems, to reduce repeated data entry. In a way that is easy to audit, our solution team stores approval rules without writing code. In a way that is easy to audit, the reporting service keeps document types that vary by vendor category. The vendor portal exposes status changes in plain language for staff, so teams can adjust the process themselves. Where needed, the rules engine keeps status changes in plain language for staff.

The configuration layer maps approval rules without writing code, and avoids custom development. Throughout the engagement, the reporting service stores a single record that finance and operations share. And avoids custom development, the vendor portal exposes simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided. Which keeps training time short, our solution team keeps reminders when documents are about to expire. Throughout the engagement, the integration gateway maps simple screens that suppliers can complete unaided. Our solution team maps document types that vary by vendor category, in a way that is easy to audit. Users see only what their role needs. And avoids custom development, the vendor portal exposes document types that vary by vendor category. The integration gateway applies each onboarding step as a configurable template, in a way that is easy to audit.

The reporting service surfaces document types that vary by vendor category, so teams can adjust the process themselves. Standard reports are included from day one. While keeping data in one place, the reporting service exposes reminders when documents are about to expire. In practice, the reporting service applies vendor fields to the right downstream systems. The reporting service keeps document types that vary by vendor category, to reduce repeated data entry. To reduce repeated data entry, the rules engine stores vendor fields to the right downstream systems. The rules engine keeps reminders when documents are about to expire, in a way that is easy to audit. While keeping data in one place, the rules engine keeps vendor fields to the right downstream systems.

## D. Data Migration, Testing and Training

We profile Northwind's vendor data in week 3, agree cleansing rules with the data owners, and run two migration rehearsals before cutover. Testing runs in three layers: automated checks in the build, a structured integration test in weeks 13 to 15, and two rounds of user acceptance testing with scenarios written together with the procurement team.

Training is role-based. Administrators receive two hands-on sessions, buyers one workshop on the approval flow, and vendors get short guides and a help page. The change manager runs a communication plan so that vendors hear about the new process at least four weeks before they are

asked to use it.

- Week 3: data profiling report and cleansing rules agreed;
- Weeks 13-15: integration test cycle with Northwind IT;
- Weeks 16-19: two UAT rounds, defects triaged daily;
- Weeks 18-21: training sessions and vendor communications;
- Week 21: final cutover rehearsal and go/no-go review.

The change manager agrees readiness for each go-live step, using plain, shared checklists. The QA lead plans the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, and records the decisions made. Each sprint plans readiness for each go-live step, before moving to the next phase. Using plain, shared checklists, the QA lead checks the next two weeks of work in a short planning session.

The delivery team plans training needs for each user group, using plain, shared checklists. At every stage, the change manager collects readiness for each go-live step. With the people who will use it, the business analyst checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Northwind approves each milestone in writing. So there are no surprises, the delivery team plans working software at the end of each sprint. Each sprint agrees progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, in a one-hour session. Before moving to the next phase, the delivery team walks through readiness for each go-live step. Throughout the engagement, our programme manager checks training needs for each user group. Each sprint demonstrates training needs for each user group, with the people who will use it.

Before moving to the next phase, the delivery team agrees readiness for each go-live step. In practice, the change manager checks the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. In a one-hour session, the delivery team checks training needs for each user group. The business analyst collects open questions that block a milestone, so there are no surprises. Using plain, shared checklists, the delivery team walks through progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. As agreed with Northwind, the change manager walks through test results before anything is released.

The QA lead collects open questions that block a milestone, with the people who will use it. As agreed with Northwind, each sprint collects progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. The QA lead checks test results before anything is released, before moving to the next phase. Where needed, the change manager checks readiness for each go-live step. Each sprint agrees the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, and records the decisions made. For each release, the change manager walks through training needs for each user group. Each sprint agrees progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, before moving to the next phase. Throughout the engagement, the business analyst walks through readiness for each go-live step. The change manager agrees progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, with the people who will use it.

And records the decisions made, the business analyst plans the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. At every stage, the QA lead collects training needs for each user group. Our programme manager plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, using plain, shared checklists. Our programme manager demonstrates working software at the end of each sprint, and records the decisions made. Northwind approves each milestone in writing. The business analyst collects open questions that block a milestone, so there are no surprises. Throughout the engagement, the change manager plans training needs for each user group. Before moving to the next phase, our programme manager collects training needs for each user group. The plan is updated after every

review.

The business analyst plans feedback from vendors in the pilot group, using plain, shared checklists. And records the decisions made, the delivery team checks readiness for each go-live step. The change manager plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, in a one-hour session. Where needed, our programme manager plans test results before anything is released. The delivery team walks through progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, using plain, shared checklists. The plan is updated after every review. Using plain, shared checklists, the business analyst plans open questions that block a milestone.

The delivery team agrees progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, using plain, shared checklists. And records the decisions made, the business analyst checks test results before anything is released. As a rule, the business analyst walks through progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. The delivery team walks through readiness for each go-live step, in a one-hour session. Where needed, the QA lead checks training needs for each user group. Each sprint walks through working software at the end of each sprint, and records the decisions made. As agreed with Northwind, the change manager demonstrates the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. The business analyst checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, in a one-hour session.

In a one-hour session, the QA lead checks test results before anything is released. The plan is updated after every review. And records the decisions made, each sprint plans training needs for each user group. So there are no surprises, the QA lead walks through feedback from vendors in the pilot group. The change manager plans working software at the end of each sprint, before moving to the next phase. And records the decisions made, the delivery team plans open questions that block a milestone. Each sprint plans working software at the end of each sprint, before moving to the next phase.

The delivery team agrees test results before anything is released, so there are no surprises. The plan is updated after every review. And records the decisions made, the delivery team plans test results before anything is released. Where needed, each sprint checks the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. Each sprint walks through open questions that block a milestone, using plain, shared checklists. Where needed, the QA lead demonstrates readiness for each go-live step. So there are no surprises, the business analyst walks through progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Owners and dates are written down. And records the decisions made, each sprint collects progress with the Northwind sponsor every week.

So there are no surprises, each sprint checks readiness for each go-live step. In practice, the change manager agrees working software at the end of each sprint. The business analyst demonstrates the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, using plain, shared checklists. Our programme manager walks through open questions that block a milestone, with the people who will use it. As agreed with Northwind, the change manager checks the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. Our programme manager walks through working software at the end of each sprint, and records the decisions made.

Our programme manager collects progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, before moving to the next phase. The delivery team plans working software at the end of each sprint, and records the decisions made. Before moving to the next phase, each sprint walks through open questions that block a milestone. Each sprint plans open questions that block a milestone, in a one-hour session. So there

are no surprises, our programme manager agrees open questions that block a milestone.

The business analyst collects open questions that block a milestone, and records the decisions made. Anything slipping is raised early. Each sprint plans working software at the end of each sprint, in a one-hour session. As a rule, our programme manager walks through test results before anything is released. Before moving to the next phase, the delivery team walks through working software at the end of each sprint. In day-to-day work, our programme manager collects open questions that block a milestone. And records the decisions made, the delivery team checks feedback from vendors in the pilot group. Where needed, our programme manager demonstrates readiness for each go-live step. The QA lead demonstrates progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, before moving to the next phase. The change manager checks readiness for each go-live step, before moving to the next phase. At every stage, the change manager walks through the next two weeks of work in a short planning session.

Using plain, shared checklists, our programme manager checks test results before anything is released. In practice, the delivery team plans the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. The business analyst collects open questions that block a milestone, with the people who will use it. The plan is updated after every review. And records the decisions made, the QA lead collects test results before anything is released. The plan is updated after every review. The business analyst checks training needs for each user group, before moving to the next phase.

So there are no surprises, each sprint checks test results before anything is released. The plan is updated after every review. Using plain, shared checklists, each sprint demonstrates test results before anything is released. Using plain, shared checklists, the change manager plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Our programme manager walks through readiness for each go-live step, with the people who will use it. In day-to-day work, the QA lead checks readiness for each go-live step.

Before moving to the next phase, our programme manager demonstrates readiness for each go-live step. The change manager demonstrates training needs for each user group, and records the decisions made. And records the decisions made, the business analyst walks through open questions that block a milestone. At every stage, the business analyst plans readiness for each go-live step. Our programme manager demonstrates the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, so there are no surprises.

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## E. Implementation Plan and Governance

The 22-week plan has six milestones, each with an acceptance checklist signed by the Northwind sponsor.

**Table 1 - Milestones**

| Milestone | Week | Owner | Acceptance |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kickoff and governance | 2 | Programme manager | Charter and RACI signed |
| Requirements baseline | 4 | Business analyst | Approved requirements |
| Configuration complete | 10 | Solution architect | Demo of all workflows |
| Integrations verified | 15 | Engineering lead | End-to-end test pass |
| User acceptance passed | 19 | QA lead | Zero open severity-1 or 2 |
| Go-live and hypercare | 22 | Programme manager | Sponsor sign-off |

The team of nine comprises a programme manager, a solution architect, four engineers, a business analyst, a QA lead and a change manager. A RACI matrix is agreed in week 1 and the programme manager reports progress, risks and decisions weekly.

**Table 2 - RACI (R responsible, A accountable, C consulted, I informed)**

| Activity | Northwind | Programme mgr | Architect | QA lead |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Requirements sign-off | A | R | C | I |
| Configuration | C | A | R | I |
| Integration testing | C | A | R | R |
| User acceptance | R | A | C | R |
| Go-live decision | A | R | C | C |

Governance has three layers: a weekly delivery review, a monthly steering group chaired by the Northwind sponsor, and a change-control board that estimates the impact of any scope change on cost and schedule before it is accepted.

Once a month, the project board tracks a log of decisions and who made them. Where needed, the risk owner tracks supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. Using a one-page template, the risk owner tracks scope changes with a short impact note. At every stage, the project board keeps dependencies on other Northwind projects. With Northwind finance present, the programme office reviews the register of risks and assumptions. Throughout the engagement, the project board keeps the register of risks and assumptions. Ahead of each milestone, the service manager publishes the register

of risks and assumptions. Actions have one owner each. So everyone sees the same facts, the programme office tracks a log of decisions and who made them. With Northwind finance present, the service manager reviews supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. In practice, the project board meets supplier-facing communications ahead of launch.

The project board meets escalations that need executive attention, with Northwind finance present. Where needed, the service manager decides on escalations that need executive attention. Every Friday, the programme office keeps budget against the agreed milestones. So everyone sees the same facts, the programme office reviews dependencies on other Northwind projects. The risk owner keeps escalations that need executive attention, once a month.

Using a one-page template, the risk owner meets the register of risks and assumptions. The project board tracks benefits against the original business case, every Friday. The sponsor can ask for a deeper review at any time. So everyone sees the same facts, a named sponsor tracks a log of decisions and who made them. Open risks are reviewed first. The programme office keeps scope changes with a short impact note, with Northwind finance present. Every Friday, the risk owner publishes supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. Throughout the engagement, the risk owner decides on the register of risks and assumptions. The project board publishes budget against the agreed milestones, so everyone sees the same facts.

So everyone sees the same facts, the service manager publishes benefits against the original business case. At every stage, the project board keeps supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. The steering group publishes budget against the agreed milestones, so everyone sees the same facts. So everyone sees the same facts, the steering group publishes budget against the agreed milestones. At every stage, the service manager reviews supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. The project board meets scope changes with a short impact note, every Friday. In day-to-day work, a named sponsor tracks benefits against the original business case.

The programme office publishes benefits against the original business case, ahead of each milestone. In day-to-day work, the steering group meets escalations that need executive attention. The project board decides on budget against the agreed milestones, ahead of each milestone. The risk owner keeps budget against the agreed milestones, with Northwind finance present. Ahead of each milestone, a named sponsor keeps the register of risks and assumptions. The project board tracks a log of decisions and who made them, with Northwind finance present. Every Friday, the service manager tracks a log of decisions and who made them.

The project board meets supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, ahead of each milestone. The programme office decides on budget against the agreed milestones, so everyone sees the same facts. Once a month, a named sponsor meets benefits against the original business case. A named sponsor meets benefits against the original business case, once a month. Actions have one owner each.

With Northwind finance present, the service manager tracks escalations that need executive attention. The project board meets scope changes with a short impact note, every Friday. The programme office meets escalations that need executive attention, once a month. The risk owner reviews escalations that need executive attention, once a month. Using a one-page template, the project board keeps scope changes with a short impact note.

So everyone sees the same facts, the risk owner decides on supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. As agreed with Northwind, the risk owner decides on escalations that need executive attention. So everyone sees the same facts, the project board keeps scope changes with a short impact note. Once a month, the programme office meets supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. The steering group decides on the register of risks and assumptions, using a one-page template. The project board decides on dependencies on other Northwind projects, ahead of each milestone. The service manager keeps supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, with Northwind finance present. For each release, the programme office publishes a log of decisions and who made them.

With Northwind finance present, the project board tracks dependencies on other Northwind projects. The programme office publishes scope changes with a short impact note, using a one-page template. At every stage, the steering group publishes a log of decisions and who made them. The risk owner decides on a log of decisions and who made them, every Friday. So everyone sees the same facts, the programme office tracks budget against the agreed milestones.

A named sponsor meets a log of decisions and who made them, so everyone sees the same facts. The steering group tracks budget against the agreed milestones, every Friday. Ahead of each milestone, the risk owner meets the register of risks and assumptions. The steering group tracks budget against the agreed milestones, using a one-page template. The risk owner reviews benefits against the original business case, with Northwind finance present.

With Northwind finance present, the project board keeps scope changes with a short impact note. The programme office reviews dependencies on other Northwind projects, with Northwind finance present. The programme office tracks budget against the agreed milestones, with Northwind finance present. The project board meets a log of decisions and who made them, with Northwind finance present.

## F. Security, Compliance and Risk Management

NexaWorks is SOC 2 Type II certified. Data is encrypted in transit and at rest, access is role-based with single sign-on and multi-factor authentication, and audit logs are retained for three years. Our ISO 27001 certification audit is scheduled for the second quarter. Annual third-party penetration testing is performed.

**Table 3 - Top five risks**

| Risk | Owner | Mitigation |
|---|---|---|
| Poor vendor data quality | Business analyst | Profiling in week 3, cleansing sprint |
| Integration endpoint availability | Engineering lead | Sandbox agreed by week 6 |
| Stakeholder capacity | Programme manager | Named Northwind delegates, weekly review |
| Scope growth | Programme manager | Change control with impact estimate |
| Go-live data migration | Solution architect | Two rehearsals before cutover |

The service manager answers availability and incident figures each month, in the first ninety days after go-live. Reviews include a short improvement plan. Our service desk tracks what changed in each release in everyday language, with a named contact. Reviews include a short improvement plan. Our service desk explains what changed in each release in everyday language, in the first ninety days

after go-live. The hypercare team answers how vendors are using the portal, within the stated response time. Our service desk reports on problems that keep coming back, by phone, email or chat. Where needed, the service manager checks in on problems that keep coming back.

And agrees next steps, the hypercare team explains questions from new administrators during the first weeks. At every stage, a support engineer checks in on what changed in each release in everyday language. The hypercare team explains how vendors are using the portal, within the stated response time. Where needed, the service manager checks in on availability and incident figures each month. Around the clock, the on-call team reports on questions from new administrators during the first weeks. In the first ninety days after go-live, the hypercare team checks in on problems that keep coming back.

Within the stated response time, the service manager follows up response times against the agreed table. Throughout the engagement, the customer success manager follows up availability and incident figures each month. A support engineer tracks response times against the agreed table, around the clock. Where needed, the customer success manager follows up how vendors are using the portal. The hypercare team reports on availability and incident figures each month, within the stated response time. Our service desk tracks open tickets until the user confirms they are resolved, by phone, email or chat. By phone, email or chat, the service manager tracks response times against the agreed table.

Within the stated response time, the hypercare team tracks every request with a reference number. In day-to-day work, the hypercare team checks in on how vendors are using the portal. Our service desk explains how vendors are using the portal, and agrees next steps. Around the clock, the service manager tracks how vendors are using the portal. A support engineer follows up problems that keep coming back, by phone, email or chat.

The on-call team answers open tickets until the user confirms they are resolved, around the clock. The on-call team answers questions from new administrators during the first weeks, within the stated response time. As a rule, the hypercare team checks in on availability and incident figures each month. Within the stated response time, the on-call team tracks how vendors are using the portal. A support engineer answers questions from new administrators during the first weeks, in the first ninety days after go-live. Around the clock, the customer success manager reports on availability and incident figures each month.

Around the clock, the customer success manager answers questions from new administrators during the first weeks. At every stage, the service manager answers what changed in each release in everyday language. The customer success manager tracks every request with a reference number, within the stated response time. By phone, email or chat, the customer success manager follows up every request with a reference number. The customer success manager tracks what changed in each release in everyday language, and agrees next steps. At every stage, our service desk tracks response times against the agreed table.

By phone, email or chat, the customer success manager follows up questions from new administrators during the first weeks. At every stage, our service desk answers what changed in each release in everyday language. The on-call team reports on availability and incident figures each month, in the first ninety days after go-live. And agrees next steps, the service manager tracks how vendors are using the portal. The hypercare team explains availability and incident figures each month, around the

clock. By phone, email or chat, the hypercare team explains what changed in each release in everyday language. In practice, a support engineer explains how vendors are using the portal.

The on-call team follows up what changed in each release in everyday language, in the first ninety days after go-live. Where needed, the hypercare team answers questions from new administrators during the first weeks. And agrees next steps, our service desk explains response times against the agreed table. Throughout the engagement, the on-call team answers every request with a reference number. And agrees next steps, a support engineer tracks what changed in each release in everyday language. Around the clock, our service desk checks in on questions from new administrators during the first weeks. Within the stated response time, the customer success manager tracks how vendors are using the portal. Throughout the engagement, the on-call team answers questions from new administrators during the first weeks. The service manager answers questions from new administrators during the first weeks, and agrees next steps. For each release, a support engineer answers open tickets until the user confirms they are resolved.

By phone, email or chat, a support engineer checks in on availability and incident figures each month. And agrees next steps, the customer success manager checks in on every request with a reference number. Reviews include a short improvement plan. A support engineer reports on every request with a reference number, and agrees next steps. Around the clock, the customer success manager checks in on how vendors are using the portal. And agrees next steps, the customer success manager checks in on response times against the agreed table. Throughout the engagement, the hypercare team explains availability and incident figures each month.

And agrees next steps, the hypercare team reports on every request with a reference number. The hypercare team answers how vendors are using the portal, in the first ninety days after go-live. The customer success manager follows up open tickets until the user confirms they are resolved, by phone, email or chat. And agrees next steps, the customer success manager reports on problems that keep coming back. Training refreshers are offered each quarter. The customer success manager answers problems that keep coming back, in the first ninety days after go-live. As a rule, the service manager follows up availability and incident figures each month.

A support engineer tracks what changed in each release in everyday language, by phone, email or chat. For each release, our service desk answers response times against the agreed table. The on-call team answers how vendors are using the portal, within the stated response time. At every stage, the service manager answers availability and incident figures each month. The customer success manager answers every request with a reference number, and agrees next steps. The customer success manager answers response times against the agreed table, with a named contact. The hypercare team checks in on problems that keep coming back, with a named contact.

The on-call team reports on problems that keep coming back, in the first ninety days after go-live. In practice, a support engineer reports on what changed in each release in everyday language. The service manager reports on how vendors are using the portal, within the stated response time. In day-to-day work, the hypercare team checks in on every request with a reference number. The hypercare team tracks questions from new administrators during the first weeks, with a named contact. With a named contact, a support engineer checks in on problems that keep coming back.

A support engineer tracks availability and incident figures each month, in the first ninety days after go-live. The customer success manager explains open tickets until the user confirms they are resolved, by phone, email or chat. A support engineer checks in on open tickets until the user confirms they are resolved, with a named contact. Customers can rate each ticket. Within the stated response time, our service desk checks in on questions from new administrators during the first weeks. The service manager follows up availability and incident figures each month, by phone, email or chat. And agrees next steps, the customer success manager answers how vendors are using the portal.

## G. Service and Support Model

Support is delivered 24x7 through three tiers with a 99.9% monthly availability SLA backed by service credits. A named customer success manager runs monthly service reviews, and a 90-day hypercare period follows go-live.

**Table 4 - Response targets**

| Severity | First response | Update cadence |
|---|---|---|
| 1 - Service down | 30 minutes | Every hour |
| 2 - Major impairment | 2 hours | Every 4 hours |
| 3 - Minor issue | 1 business day | Twice weekly |

During the 90-day hypercare period an engineer is assigned to Northwind for daily check-ins, vendor questions are answered within four working hours, and a knowledge-transfer plan hands day-to-day administration to Northwind staff with recorded sessions and runbooks. After hypercare, service reviews move to monthly.

## H. Pricing and Assumptions

**Table 5 - Fixed price for core scope**

| Item | Price (USD) |
|---|---|
| Platform licence (3-year term) | 390,000 |
| Implementation | 330,000 |
| Integrations (up to four systems) | 150,000 |
| Training and change management | 60,000 |
| Support and customer success (3 years) | 120,000 |
| **Total** | **1,050,000** |

- Prices in USD, exclusive of taxes, fixed for the core scope.
- Includes up to four system integrations.
- Optional four-week on-site hypercare is priced separately at USD 38,000.

## I. Experience and References

NexaWorks has delivered six similar platforms. Brightwater Logistics (2024) onboarded 1,800 vendors and cut onboarding time from 12 days to 4. Summit Retail Group (2023) moved 900 vendors from spreadsheets in 16 weeks. Both will take reference calls.

Lessons from those projects shape this plan: we start vendor communications early, involve buyers in acceptance testing from the first round, and keep a single accountable owner for every milestone.

## Appendix A - Detailed Work Plan

So there are no surprises, the business analyst plans open questions that block a milestone. Anything slipping is raised early. So there are no surprises, the QA lead agrees working software at the end of each sprint. The plan is updated after every review. So there are no surprises, the QA lead walks through test results before anything is released. For each release, the change manager checks training needs for each user group. The change manager agrees readiness for each go-live step, before moving to the next phase. Our programme manager agrees feedback from vendors in the pilot group, using plain, shared checklists. In day-to-day work, the change manager demonstrates test results before anything is released.

So there are no surprises, our programme manager agrees the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. In day-to-day work, the delivery team collects readiness for each go-live step. The delivery team collects the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, before moving to the next phase. Northwind approves each milestone in writing. So there are no surprises, each sprint walks through working software at the end of each sprint. Northwind approves each milestone in writing. Before moving to the next phase, the business analyst demonstrates progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. The change manager walks through the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, before moving to the next phase. Each sprint walks through training needs for each user group, using plain, shared checklists. The plan is updated after every review.

The QA lead demonstrates readiness for each go-live step, with the people who will use it. For each release, the change manager checks readiness for each go-live step. In a one-hour session, the delivery team collects training needs for each user group. For each release, the delivery team demonstrates progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. The change manager walks through test results before anything is released, with the people who will use it. With the people who will use it, the change manager checks test results before anything is released.

The delivery team collects training needs for each user group, in a one-hour session. As agreed with Northwind, the delivery team agrees feedback from vendors in the pilot group. Using plain, shared checklists, our programme manager walks through test results before anything is released. For each release, the QA lead collects progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Each sprint walks through the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, before moving to the next phase. Before moving to the next phase, our programme manager checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Throughout the engagement, each sprint collects the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. Each sprint agrees the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, and records the decisions made. Before moving to the next phase, the change manager collects progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Anything slipping is raised early.

Before moving to the next phase, our programme manager collects readiness for each go-live step. Using plain, shared checklists, our programme manager walks through test results before anything is released. The business analyst demonstrates feedback from vendors in the pilot group, and records the decisions made. Each sprint plans feedback from vendors in the pilot group, with the people who will use it.

With the people who will use it, the business analyst checks feedback from vendors in the pilot group. Before moving to the next phase, our programme manager plans open questions that block a

milestone. In a one-hour session, the delivery team demonstrates test results before anything is released. The plan is updated after every review. The change manager collects feedback from vendors in the pilot group, in a one-hour session. Throughout the engagement, the delivery team demonstrates working software at the end of each sprint. With the people who will use it, the QA lead demonstrates working software at the end of each sprint.

So there are no surprises, our programme manager collects test results before anything is released. As a rule, our programme manager collects feedback from vendors in the pilot group. So there are no surprises, our programme manager agrees feedback from vendors in the pilot group. With the people who will use it, the change manager checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Where needed, the delivery team agrees training needs for each user group. Each sprint plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, before moving to the next phase. At every stage, our programme manager collects training needs for each user group. Before moving to the next phase, the delivery team plans feedback from vendors in the pilot group. Throughout the engagement, the business analyst walks through test results before anything is released.

The change manager checks the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, and records the decisions made. Throughout the engagement, each sprint agrees feedback from vendors in the pilot group. Before moving to the next phase, each sprint agrees progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. With the people who will use it, each sprint agrees training needs for each user group. As agreed with Northwind, the change manager plans training needs for each user group. And records the decisions made, our programme manager plans readiness for each go-live step. Using plain, shared checklists, the QA lead collects the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. The QA lead collects the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, using plain, shared checklists. The plan is updated after every review.

The business analyst checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, so there are no surprises. Our programme manager plans training needs for each user group, with the people who will use it. Anything slipping is raised early. Our programme manager demonstrates feedback from vendors in the pilot group, so there are no surprises. Before moving to the next phase, the QA lead checks feedback from vendors in the pilot group.

And records the decisions made, the business analyst collects readiness for each go-live step. The plan is updated after every review. Using plain, shared checklists, the delivery team agrees open questions that block a milestone. The delivery team plans test results before anything is released, using plain, shared checklists. With the people who will use it, the business analyst collects test results before anything is released. Using plain, shared checklists, our programme manager plans the next two weeks of work in a short planning session.

Our programme manager walks through working software at the end of each sprint, before moving to the next phase. Owners and dates are written down. Each sprint collects training needs for each user group, before moving to the next phase. Before moving to the next phase, the QA lead plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Before moving to the next phase, the business analyst collects working software at the end of each sprint. The QA lead checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, using plain, shared checklists.

The delivery team checks working software at the end of each sprint, so there are no surprises. Throughout the engagement, the business analyst walks through the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. The change manager checks the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, in a one-hour session. The QA lead agrees open questions that block a milestone, using plain, shared checklists. For each release, our programme manager demonstrates working software at the end of each sprint. Using plain, shared checklists, the delivery team checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. In a one-hour session, our programme manager demonstrates working software at the end of each sprint. And records the decisions made, our programme manager demonstrates the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. For each release, the QA lead plans working software at the end of each sprint.

Our programme manager agrees open questions that block a milestone, with the people who will use it. As a rule, the business analyst checks training needs for each user group. So there are no surprises, the QA lead demonstrates training needs for each user group. Using plain, shared checklists, the business analyst checks readiness for each go-live step. Each sprint demonstrates the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, in a one-hour session. The change manager checks open questions that block a milestone, using plain, shared checklists. Using plain, shared checklists, each sprint demonstrates open questions that block a milestone. Anything slipping is raised early.

Each sprint collects open questions that block a milestone, and records the decisions made. The QA lead demonstrates training needs for each user group, and records the decisions made. Anything slipping is raised early. Our programme manager collects test results before anything is released, so there are no surprises. In day-to-day work, our programme manager demonstrates readiness for each go-live step. Using plain, shared checklists, our programme manager plans test results before anything is released. Before moving to the next phase, our programme manager checks feedback from vendors in the pilot group.

And records the decisions made, the delivery team collects working software at the end of each sprint. The change manager collects open questions that block a milestone, and records the decisions made. Before moving to the next phase, the change manager checks readiness for each go-live step. The delivery team walks through open questions that block a milestone, in a one-hour session.

The QA lead plans feedback from vendors in the pilot group, with the people who will use it. Throughout the engagement, the business analyst demonstrates test results before anything is released. Each sprint checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, with the people who will use it. Anything slipping is raised early. So there are no surprises, our programme manager collects the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. The QA lead checks training needs for each user group, using plain, shared checklists.

With the people who will use it, the QA lead demonstrates test results before anything is released. Using plain, shared checklists, the business analyst plans feedback from vendors in the pilot group. The change manager checks working software at the end of each sprint, and records the decisions made. The QA lead plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, with the people who will use it. Throughout the engagement, the business analyst checks test results before anything is released.

The QA lead walks through progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, and records the decisions made. In a one-hour session, the change manager checks test results before anything is released. Anything slipping is raised early. The business analyst collects readiness for each go-live step, using plain, shared checklists. Using plain, shared checklists, the QA lead collects working software at the end of each sprint. And records the decisions made, our programme manager walks through the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. With the people who will use it, our programme manager plans feedback from vendors in the pilot group. In day-to-day work, our programme manager demonstrates test results before anything is released.

The business analyst demonstrates feedback from vendors in the pilot group, using plain, shared checklists. As a rule, the change manager checks feedback from vendors in the pilot group. Using plain, shared checklists, our programme manager collects the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. For each release, the business analyst demonstrates test results before anything is released. In a one-hour session, the delivery team checks open questions that block a milestone. The delivery team plans the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, and records the decisions made. At every stage, the delivery team plans test results before anything is released. And records the decisions made, the change manager plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. At every stage, the business analyst plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week.

The change manager walks through readiness for each go-live step, before moving to the next phase. The QA lead collects the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, in a one-hour session. Using plain, shared checklists, our programme manager plans the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. As agreed with Northwind, our programme manager collects progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. So there are no surprises, our programme manager checks open questions that block a milestone. In day-to-day work, the change manager checks test results before anything is released.

The delivery team walks through progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, in a one-hour session. The business analyst demonstrates the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, so there are no surprises. For each release, the delivery team collects feedback from vendors in the pilot group. In a one-hour session, the change manager plans open questions that block a milestone. So there are no surprises, the change manager checks progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. Northwind approves each milestone in writing.

In a one-hour session, the business analyst agrees working software at the end of each sprint. In practice, each sprint plans the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. With the people who will use it, our programme manager walks through feedback from vendors in the pilot group. The plan is updated after every review. The delivery team demonstrates the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, with the people who will use it. The business analyst plans feedback from vendors in the pilot group, using plain, shared checklists. Throughout the engagement, each sprint collects training needs for each user group. So there are no surprises, our programme manager demonstrates feedback from vendors in the pilot group. Where needed, the change manager checks training needs for each user group.

Before moving to the next phase, our programme manager agrees training needs for each user group. Northwind approves each milestone in writing. So there are no surprises, our programme manager collects feedback from vendors in the pilot group. Our programme manager walks through progress

with the Northwind sponsor every week, in a one-hour session. With the people who will use it, the business analyst collects test results before anything is released. The QA lead demonstrates training needs for each user group, with the people who will use it. At every stage, each sprint checks working software at the end of each sprint.

Using plain, shared checklists, the QA lead collects readiness for each go-live step. Using plain, shared checklists, the business analyst plans progress with the Northwind sponsor every week. The delivery team walks through test results before anything is released, and records the decisions made. The delivery team checks test results before anything is released, so there are no surprises. So there are no surprises, the QA lead collects progress with the Northwind sponsor every week.

Each sprint demonstrates feedback from vendors in the pilot group, with the people who will use it. For each release, the delivery team agrees feedback from vendors in the pilot group. The QA lead agrees working software at the end of each sprint, before moving to the next phase. The business analyst walks through readiness for each go-live step, with the people who will use it. With the people who will use it, the QA lead demonstrates test results before anything is released. Before moving to the next phase, the delivery team plans readiness for each go-live step. The QA lead collects working software at the end of each sprint, using plain, shared checklists. Owners and dates are written down.

The change manager walks through the next two weeks of work in a short planning session, with the people who will use it. So there are no surprises, the QA lead checks the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. With the people who will use it, our programme manager plans the next two weeks of work in a short planning session. Each sprint demonstrates progress with the Northwind sponsor every week, and records the decisions made. Owners and dates are written down. Each sprint plans working software at the end of each sprint, before moving to the next phase. The QA lead checks feedback from vendors in the pilot group, in a one-hour session. Throughout the engagement, each sprint agrees readiness for each go-live step.

## Appendix B - Governance and Reporting

Using a one-page template, the project board reviews scope changes with a short impact note. For each release, the service manager meets the register of risks and assumptions. The project board meets supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, every Friday. As agreed with Northwind, the service manager keeps escalations that need executive attention. Once a month, the programme office keeps supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. Every Friday, the steering group publishes the register of risks and assumptions.

Using a one-page template, the service manager meets a log of decisions and who made them. As a rule, the risk owner keeps budget against the agreed milestones. Using a one-page template, the risk owner decides on escalations that need executive attention. The service manager tracks the register of risks and assumptions, using a one-page template. At every stage, a named sponsor tracks the register of risks and assumptions. The project board publishes the register of risks and assumptions, once a month.

So everyone sees the same facts, the programme office reviews the register of risks and assumptions. Ahead of each milestone, the steering group reviews supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. So everyone sees the same facts, a named sponsor tracks supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. So everyone sees the same facts, the programme office meets scope changes with a short

impact note. Once a month, a named sponsor decides on the register of risks and assumptions. As a rule, the steering group tracks the register of risks and assumptions. Once a month, the risk owner publishes benefits against the original business case. As a rule, the programme office publishes dependencies on other Northwind projects.

With Northwind finance present, a named sponsor reviews scope changes with a short impact note. With Northwind finance present, a named sponsor decides on escalations that need executive attention. With Northwind finance present, the risk owner tracks supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. The risk owner keeps the register of risks and assumptions, ahead of each milestone. Where needed, the steering group keeps dependencies on other Northwind projects. The service manager decides on benefits against the original business case, ahead of each milestone.

The project board tracks the register of risks and assumptions, ahead of each milestone. A named sponsor decides on benefits against the original business case, using a one-page template. The steering group reviews supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, every Friday. Every Friday, the service manager tracks the register of risks and assumptions. With Northwind finance present, the programme office keeps benefits against the original business case. With Northwind finance present, the project board keeps supplier-facing communications ahead of launch.

The risk owner publishes dependencies on other Northwind projects, with Northwind finance present. In day-to-day work, the programme office decides on a log of decisions and who made them. The service manager decides on dependencies on other Northwind projects, every Friday. Once a month, the risk owner keeps escalations that need executive attention. The service manager reviews supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, every Friday.

The risk owner decides on a log of decisions and who made them, ahead of each milestone. The service manager tracks the register of risks and assumptions, every Friday. A named sponsor keeps dependencies on other Northwind projects, ahead of each milestone. In practice, the project board keeps benefits against the original business case. A named sponsor reviews benefits against the original business case, once a month. A named sponsor keeps supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, every Friday. As agreed with Northwind, the project board decides on dependencies on other Northwind projects. Using a one-page template, a named sponsor tracks scope changes with a short impact note.

The service manager publishes dependencies on other Northwind projects, using a one-page template. In practice, the steering group meets scope changes with a short impact note. Using a one-page template, the risk owner meets a log of decisions and who made them. The risk owner reviews the register of risks and assumptions, ahead of each milestone. At every stage, the service manager tracks dependencies on other Northwind projects. So everyone sees the same facts, the risk owner decides on a log of decisions and who made them. For each release, the risk owner publishes the register of risks and assumptions. With Northwind finance present, a named sponsor reviews budget against the agreed milestones.

The service manager keeps supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, so everyone sees the same facts. Throughout the engagement, the service manager meets scope changes with a short impact note. Ahead of each milestone, the project board publishes budget against the agreed milestones. As agreed with Northwind, the project board keeps scope changes with a short impact note. Using a

one-page template, the project board decides on benefits against the original business case. In practice, a named sponsor decides on dependencies on other Northwind projects. Once a month, the service manager meets benefits against the original business case.

Using a one-page template, the project board meets escalations that need executive attention. Where needed, the risk owner meets a log of decisions and who made them. Ahead of each milestone, the project board keeps supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. The project board tracks benefits against the original business case, ahead of each milestone. The steering group decides on scope changes with a short impact note, with Northwind finance present.

The steering group tracks scope changes with a short impact note, using a one-page template. The programme office publishes the register of risks and assumptions, once a month. The programme office meets scope changes with a short impact note, so everyone sees the same facts. Where needed, a named sponsor decides on a log of decisions and who made them. The programme office meets the register of risks and assumptions, once a month. In day-to-day work, the service manager reviews dependencies on other Northwind projects. The programme office reviews scope changes with a short impact note, so everyone sees the same facts. At every stage, the steering group publishes scope changes with a short impact note. The steering group keeps a log of decisions and who made them, using a one-page template.

The risk owner decides on supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, using a one-page template. Using a one-page template, the risk owner publishes a log of decisions and who made them. The project board publishes supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, with Northwind finance present. With Northwind finance present, a named sponsor meets dependencies on other Northwind projects. Throughout the engagement, the steering group keeps the register of risks and assumptions.

The project board publishes scope changes with a short impact note, every Friday. As a rule, the service manager reviews the register of risks and assumptions. So everyone sees the same facts, the project board keeps supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. Using a one-page template, the steering group tracks benefits against the original business case. The steering group meets escalations that need executive attention, ahead of each milestone. In day-to-day work, the programme office keeps budget against the agreed milestones.

The programme office reviews scope changes with a short impact note, every Friday. A named sponsor decides on budget against the agreed milestones, using a one-page template. Using a one-page template, the project board decides on a log of decisions and who made them. With Northwind finance present, the project board decides on budget against the agreed milestones. The programme office publishes the register of risks and assumptions, every Friday.

Every Friday, the service manager reviews dependencies on other Northwind projects. Where needed, the project board publishes supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. The steering group reviews escalations that need executive attention, every Friday. The steering group keeps scope changes with a short impact note, with Northwind finance present. So everyone sees the same facts, the risk owner meets supplier-facing communications ahead of launch. Once a month, the programme office tracks supplier-facing communications ahead of launch.

The service manager meets budget against the agreed milestones, every Friday. At every stage, the project board meets escalations that need executive attention. The steering group publishes a log of

decisions and who made them, using a one-page template. The project board decides on a log of decisions and who made them, once a month. So everyone sees the same facts, the steering group decides on benefits against the original business case. So everyone sees the same facts, the steering group keeps a log of decisions and who made them. Open risks are reviewed first.

The service manager keeps benefits against the original business case, with Northwind finance present. The service manager decides on supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, every Friday. The project board tracks dependencies on other Northwind projects, using a one-page template. Throughout the engagement, the project board publishes benefits against the original business case. The steering group decides on budget against the agreed milestones, with Northwind finance present. Once a month, the steering group publishes scope changes with a short impact note. For each release, the steering group publishes the register of risks and assumptions.

The risk owner tracks a log of decisions and who made them, ahead of each milestone. Using a one-page template, the risk owner tracks benefits against the original business case. As agreed with Northwind, the steering group reviews a log of decisions and who made them. Ahead of each milestone, a named sponsor tracks benefits against the original business case. The steering group decides on scope changes with a short impact note, once a month.

The project board meets scope changes with a short impact note, using a one-page template. Open risks are reviewed first. With Northwind finance present, the risk owner reviews benefits against the original business case. Throughout the engagement, the project board keeps the register of risks and assumptions. The programme office publishes escalations that need executive attention, ahead of each milestone. The sponsor can ask for a deeper review at any time. The risk owner meets budget against the agreed milestones, so everyone sees the same facts. With Northwind finance present, the programme office reviews a log of decisions and who made them. As a rule, the steering group publishes dependencies on other Northwind projects.

Ahead of each milestone, the programme office tracks escalations that need executive attention. Actions have one owner each. Once a month, the project board tracks escalations that need executive attention. The project board publishes dependencies on other Northwind projects, every Friday. The risk owner meets scope changes with a short impact note, ahead of each milestone. With Northwind finance present, the project board meets the register of risks and assumptions.

The service manager meets benefits against the original business case, once a month. A named sponsor tracks the register of risks and assumptions, using a one-page template. Where needed, the risk owner keeps dependencies on other Northwind projects. Once a month, a named sponsor decides on dependencies on other Northwind projects. The risk owner keeps escalations that need executive attention, so everyone sees the same facts.

The risk owner decides on escalations that need executive attention, once a month. So everyone sees the same facts, the project board decides on the register of risks and assumptions. In day-to-day work, the programme office meets a log of decisions and who made them. The service manager publishes supplier-facing communications ahead of launch, every Friday. A named sponsor decides on escalations that need executive attention, ahead of each milestone. Throughout the engagement, the service manager reviews benefits against the original business case. Once a month, the programme office tracks scope changes with a short impact note.